AR-01 Adult Airway

CLAIBORNE COUNTY EMS | MEDICAL-DIRECTOR APPROVED | SOURCE PDF | OCTOBER 17, 2026

Scope: Adult with actual or threatened obstruction, inadequate oxygenation or ventilation, or inability to protect the airway. A secure airway is one that provides effective oxygenation and ventilation, not simply an advanced device.

Field flow

1. Assess	Rate, work, patency, oxygenation, ventilation, and mental status.
2. Basic first	Position, suction, OPA/NPA, and two-person BVM with PEEP when indicated.
3. Escalate	All levels: oxygen/BVM. AEMT/Paramedic: authorized NIPPV or BIAD. Paramedic: intubation when clinically indicated.
4. Confirm	Waveform EtCO2 after ETT/BIAD, secure, monitor, and transport. Use AR-02 if ineffective.

Provider-level actions

Level	Approved actions
EMT	Position/open the airway, suction, basic adjuncts, oxygen, and effective two-person BVM with PEEP when indicated. Do not delay transport solely to place an advanced airway.
AEMT	All EMT care plus authorized BIAD placement and continuous waveform capnography once available. ETT and video laryngoscopy are not AEMT procedures in this protocol.
Paramedic	All prior care plus ETT, DAI when authorized, advanced-airway selection, chest decompression when indicated, and surgical airway for cannot-oxygenate/cannot-ventilate failure.

AR-01 Adult Airway

SAFETY, MEDICATION, AND LINKED-PATHWAY REFERENCE

Safety and escalation

• Target adult ventilation at approximately 10-12 breaths/min with visible chest rise; use EtCO2 and clinical response to avoid hyperventilation.

• No more than three total intubation attempts by the most experienced Paramedic. Every further attempt must meaningfully change provider, approach, positioning, or equipment.

• Effective BVM is an acceptable definitive field airway. Do not delay oxygenation or ventilation for repeated laryngoscopy.

• Use DOPE for sudden deterioration: displacement, obstruction, pneumothorax, equipment failure.

Linked pathways

AR-02 Adult Failed Airway; AR-03 Drug-Assisted Airway; AR-08 Post-Intubation / BIAD Management.

Source control

• This controlled direct source PDF replaces the prior source file and matches approved Claiborne EMS app content released October 17, 2026.

• Use current Claiborne standing orders, formulary, equipment authorization, and Medical Control direction whenever they govern a case-specific decision.